Shrek - Screenplay

By Ted Elliott, Terry Rossio, Joe Stillman and Roger S.H. Schulman (based loosely on the book by William Steig)

SHREK: **(Pg 1)** Once upon a time there was a lovely princess. But she had an enchantment upon her which could only be broken by love's first kiss. She was locked away in a castle guarded by a terrible fire-breathing dragon. She waited in the dragon's keep in the highest room of the tallest tower for her true love and true love's first kiss. *(laughs)* Like that's ever gonna happen!

INTRODUCTION

Join me today for a fractured fairy tale about a smelly ogre with a bad disposition. He sets out on a quest to rescue a beautiful princess from a fire-breathing dragon. The princess packs a punch, however, that softens his heart.

And through the story, we learn 3 very essential lessons: 1) The importance of being our authentic selves, for true beauty is found within; 2) You don't have to be what everyone expects you to be; and 3) True love is often found in unexpected places and people.

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Shrek is going about his day, perhaps digging up onions for dinner, or cleaning the windows of his cottage.

HEAD GUARD: **(Pg 5)** *(with false bravado --- he's really scared of ogres)* You there. Ogre!

SHREK: *(he turns)* Aye?

HEAD GUARD: By the order of Lord Farquaad I am authorized to place you under arrest and transport you to a designated resettlement facility.

SHREK: *(menancingly)* Oh, really? You and what army? *(the guard looks behind him to see that no one is behind him) (Shrek makes a move toward the guard, who screams and runs) (laughing Shrek returns to his work – Donkey enters)*

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DONKEY: Wow! Those guards! They thought they was all that. Then BAM! They was trippin' over themselves. Incredible! **(Pg 6)** You're a mean, green, fightin' machine! *(Shrek turns and regards Donkey for a moment, then roars very loudly)* Oh, wow! That was really scary. *(reacts to the smell of Shrek's breath)* If that don't work, your breath certainly will get the job done. You need some Tic Tacs or somethin' cause your breath stinks! *(Shrek covers his mouth, embarrassed)*

SHREK: **(Pg 7)** I am an ogre, you know. "Grab your torch and pitchforks." Doesn't that bother you?

DONKEY: Nope. I like you. What's your name?

SHREK: *(taken aback – no one likes an ogre)* Uh, Shrek. *(he walks away, but Donkey follows)*

DONKEY: You know what I like about you, Shrek? You got that kind of I-don't-care-what-nobody-thinks-of-me thing. I respect that. You all right. *(Shrek shakes his head, exasperated and turns to go inside his cottage)* **(Pg 6)** Hey, wait a minute! I got a great idea! I'll stick with you. Together we'll scare the spit out of anybody that crosses us.

*******Scene – The next morning*******

SHREK: **(Pg 11)** *(Shrek is awoken by loud noises of chaos outside – It sounds like a party – He angrily rushes outside and roars)* What are you doing in my swamp? *(the crowd goes silent)*

PINOCCHIO: *(gulps, then answers)* We were forced to come here. Lord Farquaad huffed and he puffed and he . . . signed an eviction notice.

SHREK: *(heavy sigh)* **(Pg 12)** Okay. Attention, all fairy tale things. I'm gonna see this guy Farquad right now and get you all off my land and back where you came from! *(the crowd cheers)* Do not get comfortable. Your welcome is officially worn out. Who know where this Farquaad guy is?

DONKEY: Oh, I do. I know where he is?

SHREK: *(purposely ignoring Donkey - overlapping)* Anyone else? Anyone at all?

DONKEY: Oh! Oh, pick me! I know! Me . . . Me!

SHREK: *(sighs)* Okay, fine. You're comin' with me *(Shrek and Donkey exit)*

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*******Scene – Lord Farquaad's Castle*******

FARQUAAD: (Pg 13) *(speaking to a few fairy tale creatures)* I'm not the monster here. You are. You and the rest of that fairy tale trash, poisoning my perfect world. *(he motions for them to leave, then turns to the Magic Mirror on the Wall)* **(Pg 15)** Mirror, mirror on the wall. Is this not the most perfect kingdom of them all?

MIRROR: Well, technically you're not a king. *(Farquadd responds as if to smash the mirror)* What I mean is you're not a king YET. But you can become one. All you have to do is marry a princess. *(chuckles nervously, then continues as a game show host)* So, just sit back and relax, my lord, because it's time for you to meet today's eligible bachelorettes. Bachelorette number one – Cinderella! Her hobbies include cooking and cleaning for her two evil sisters. *(Cinderella strikes a pose)* Bachelorette number two – Snow White! Although she lives with seven other men, she's not easy. *(Snow White strikes a pose)* And last, but certainly not last, Bachelorette number three is a fiery redhead who likes pina coladas and getting caught in the rain. Yours for the rescuing -- Princess Fiona! *(Fiona strikes a pose)*

FARQUAAD: (Pg 16) Princess Fiona. She's perfect! *(to himself)* All I have to do is find someone who can go . . .

MIRROR: I should probably mention the little thing that happens after sunset . . .

FARQUAAD: Silence!

*******Scene – Shrek and Donkey arrive in DuLoc*******

DONKEY: (Pg 17) That's it! That's DuLoc!

SHREK: *(looking up at a 40-story castle)* So, that must be Lord Farquaad's castle.

(As they approach the gates to the city, Donkey knocks on the gate and music begins to play – 2 wooden people emerge from each side of the gate and begin to sing)

WOODEN PEOPLE: (Pg 18-19) *(Singing and dancing)*

Don't make waves, stay in line
And we'll get along fine
DuLoc is the perfect place
Please keep off of the grass
Shine your shoes, wipe your... face
DuLoc is, DuLoc is

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DuLoc is the perfect place.
(Donkey and Shrek respond; Shrek is disgusted and Donkey excited)

DONKEY: Wow! Let's do that again! *(Inside the gates, a trumpet sounds and Lord Farquaad is speaking to a group of knights)*

FARQUAAD: Brave knights, today one of you shall have the honor – no, no – the privilege to rescue the lovely Princess Fiona from the fiery keep of the dragon. Some of you may die, but it's a sacrifice I am willing to make. *(he notices Shrek)* Oh! What is that? It's hideous! *(Shrek points to himself, confused)* Knights, new plan! The one who kills the ogre will be named champion! *(A fight ensues – Suffice to say that Shrek kicks butt) (Somewhat disgusted with the poor showing of his knight, Farquaad sighs)* **(Pg 20-21)** Congratulations, ogre. You've won the honor of embarking on a great and noble quest.

SHREK: Quest? I'm already on a quest – a quest to get my swamp back. My swamp! Where you dumped those fairy tale creatures!

FARQUAAD: All, right, I'll make you a deal. Go on this quest for me, and I'll give you your swamp back. *(as Donkey and Shrek leave DuLoc)*

DONKEY: Let me get this straight. You're gonna go fight a dragon and rescue a princess just so Farquaad will give you back a swamp. I don't get it. Why don't you just pull some of that ogre stuff on him? Throttle him, grind his bones to make your bread . . .

SHREK: **(Pg 27)** *(interrupting)* Donkey, two things, okay? Shut . . . . Up!

*******Scene – Shrek and Donkey arrive at the Dragon's tower*******

SHREK: The princess will be up the stairs in the highest room in the tallest tower. Go over there and see if you can find any stairs *(Shrek walks off)*

DONKEY: *(talking to himself)* Cool. You handle the dragon. I'll handle the stairs. I'm the stair master! *(Donkey rounds a corner and . . .)* **(Pg 28)** Aah! DRAGON!!! *(Dragon roars and flaps its wings)* That's one dazzling smile you got there. And you know what else? *(flaps turn decidedly "show-girl")* You're a girl Dragon! Just reeking of feminine beauty. *(Dragon flutters her eyes)* SHREK!

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*******Scene – Shrek arrives at Fiona's Room*******

Fiona appears to be asleep. Shrek enters, looks at her and she puckers her lips. Shrek is not entranced. He takes her by the shoulders and shakes her.

SHREK: (Pg 29) Wake up! *(she rouses)* Are you Princess Fiona? Let's go!

FIONA: Wait! You should sweep me off my feet out yonder window and down a rope onto your valiant steed. Recite an epic poem for me. A ballad? Something!

SHREK: Yesh, sorry, lady. There's no time *(the dragon roars)*

FIONA: *(surprised – she looks out the window)* You didn't slay the dragon? *(Shrek grabs Fiona and runs out. He grabs Donkey and delivers them all to safety)* **(Pg 32)** You did it! You rescued me! You're amazing. **(Pg 34)** It's destiny! A princess locked in a tower and beset by a dragon is rescued by a brave knight, and then they share true love's first kiss.

DONKEY: With Shrek? Wait. You think that Shrek is your true love? *(Donkey and Shrek burst out laughing)*

SHREK: (Pg 40-41) Look . . . I'm better off alone. People take one look at me and go "Aah! Help! Run! A big, stupid, ugly ogre!" They judge me before they even know me.

FIONA: (Pg 35) But, I **have** to be rescued by my true love, not by some ogre and his . . . his pet. *(Donkey is offended)*

SHREK: Princess, I was sent to rescue you by Lord Farquaad. He is the one who wants to marry you.

FIONA: (Pg 36) And what of my groom-to-be? Lord Farquaad? What's he like?

DONKEY: There are those who think ***little*** of him. *(he laughs)*

SHREK: Let me put it this way, Princess. Men of Farquaad's stature are in ***short*** supply *(he laughs)* **(Pg 37)** But I'll let you do the "measuring" when you see him tomorrow. *(Shrek exits to find a place to camp)*

FIONA: *(to Donkey)* Tomorrow? *(she's obviously worried)* It'll take that long? *(she notices the setting sun)* **(Pg 51)** Sunset? Oh, no!

MIRROR: (Pg 16) *(echoing voice off stage)* I should probably mention the little thing that happens after sunset . . .

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FIONA: (Pg 53-54) Oh, no! *(Fiona begins to change into an ogre, burping and farting may be involved))*

DONKEY: *(freaking out)* Aah! *(calling off)* Shrek! Shrek! What did you do with the princess? *(shocked)* You ate [her]?!!!

SHREK: (Pg 56) *(cut to Shrek to is talking to himself as he picks a flower, he practices)* Princess? I saw this flower and thought of you because it's pretty. Well, I don't really like it, but I thought you might 'cause you're pretty. But I like you anyway! *(he continues to practice in pantomime)*

FIONA: (Pg 54-56) Donkey, I'm the princess. In this body. It only happens when the sun goes down. *(sighs)* When I was a little girl, a witch cast a spell on me . . . until you find true love's first kiss . . . and take love's true form." Every night I become this horrible, ugly beast! That's why I have to marry Lord Farquaad before the sun sets tomorrow and he sees me like this! *(Shrek approaches the clearing just in time to hear . . .)* I mean, really, who can ever love a beast so hideous and ugly. "Princess" and "ugly" don't go together. *(Shrek heaves a deep sigh, throws the flower down and walks away)*

DONKEY: Princess, how 'bout you **don't** marry Farquaad . . . You're kind of an orge, and Shrek – well, you got a lot in common.

*******Scene – The next morning*******

(Fiona sees the rising sun and as it rises, she turns back into a human – she searches for Shrek who never returned the night before)

FIONA: (Pg 57-58) Shrek? Shrek! There's something I want . . . I have to tell you.

SHREK: You don't have to tell me anything, Princess. I heard enough last night. Like you said, "Who could love a hideous, ugly beast?"

FIONA: *(misunderstanding)* But I thought that wouldn't matter to you.

SHREK: *(also misunderstanding)* Yeah? Well, it does. *(Fiona looks at him in shock and dejected, she exits – Donkey enters)*

DONKEY: Shrek, what are you doing? You're letting her get away.

SHREK: Yeah? So what?

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DONKEY: Shrek, there's something about her you don't know. I talked to her last night . . . **(Pg 63)** All she ever did was like you, maybe even love you.

SHREK: Love me? She said I was ugly, a hideous creature. I heard the two of you talking.

DONKEY: She wasn't talkin' about you! She was talking about . . . Why don't you just go ask her?

SHREK: **(Pg 67-68)** *(Overcome by emotion, Shrek swallows his pride and searches for Fiona)* Fiona! I need to talk to you.

FIONA: *(angrily)* Oh, **now** you wanna talk? It's a little late for that.

SHREK: *(hesitantly)* You can't marry [Farquaad] . . . He's not your true love.

FARQUAAD: **(Pg 13)** *(echoing)* I'm not the monster here. You are. You and the rest of that fairy tale trash, poisoning my perfect world.

FIONA: And what do you know about true love?

SHREK: Well, I . . . uh . . . I mean . . . *(he gathers his courage)* **(Pg 70)** I – I love you.

FIONA: *(smiles)* I love you too! *(they kiss – and the magic of the spell begins to work)*

SHREK: **(Pg 1)** Once upon a time there was a lovely princess. But she had an enchantment upon her which could only be broken by love's first kiss.

WHISPER: *(echoing)* **(Pg 71)** Until you find true love's first kiss and take love's true form . . . true form . . . true form. . . *(Fiona is transformed into her true self – an ogre – some burping and farthing may be involved)*

SHREK: *(Shrek is shocked and overjoyed)* Fiona? You are beautiful! *(burps, the both laugh and kiss again)*

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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